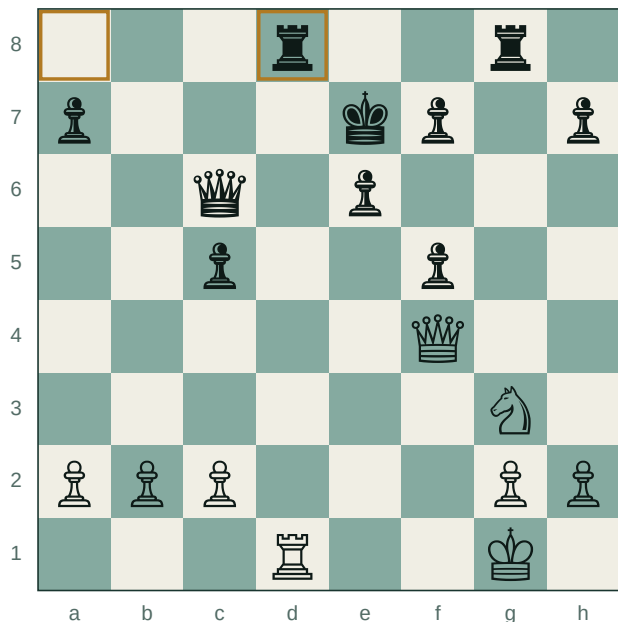


Deflection tactics: White, move 22

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 21...Rad8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22. Qh4+ f6 23. Qxh7+ Kf8 24. Rxd8+

22.Qh4+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **22...f6**.

23.Qxh7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From h7 it attacks king on e7 and rook on g8. Recorded reply: **23...Kf8**.

24.Rxd8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e7. Geometrically undefended: queen on c6. Check for tactical protection.